

Kum ba yah

Text: African American spiritual

Music: African American spiritual

KUM BA YAH 88.85

The musical score is written for guitar and four-part vocal harmony. The key signature has three flats (Bb, Eb, Ab) and the time signature is 3/4. The guitar part is shown with chords and fingerings: D^b (1 1 1 4), G^b (3 1 2 1), D^b (1 1 1 4), G^b (3 1 2 1), and A^b (4 1 3 2). The vocal parts are arranged in four lines, each with a different starting pitch. The lyrics are as follows:

1 *Kum ba yah, my Lord, kum ba yah. Kum ba yah, my Lord, kum ba yah.
2 Some-one's sing - ing, Lord, kum ba yah. Some-one's sing - ing, Lord, kum ba yah.
3 Some-one's laugh-ing, Lord, kum ba yah. Some-one's laugh-ing, Lord, kum ba yah.
4 Some-one's weep-ing, Lord, kum ba yah. Some-one's weep-ing, Lord, kum ba yah.

The second system of the score continues the melody and harmony. The guitar chords are D^b (1 1 1 4), G^b (3 1 2 1), D^b (1 1 1 4), E^bm (3 4 2 1), D^b (1 1 1 4), A^b7 (1 3 2 4), and D^b (1 1 1 4). The lyrics for the second system are:

Kum ba yah, my Lord, kum ba yah. Oh, Lord, kum ba yah!
Some-one's sing - ing, Lord, kum ba yah. Oh, Lord, kum ba yah!
Some-one's laugh-ing, Lord, kum ba yah. Oh, Lord, kum ba yah!
Some-one's weep-ing, Lord, kum ba yah. Oh, Lord, kum ba yah!

*Come by here